



FOR THOUSANDS OF YEARS TIBETAN PEOPLE have been living in

TIBETANS

AN ANCIENT BUDDHIST PEOPLE

Tibet and areas that are now part of China, India, Nepal, and Bhutan. The Tibetan culture, in particular their written language

Tibetan nomads

The Tibetan Plateau lies north of the Himalayas and is a huge, rugged plain where an estimated one million nomads live. The land cannot be farmed so the nomads are the only inhabitants. Some nomads have a winter home and travel with livestock at various times during the year.

The storms are sometimes so bad on the Tibetan plateau that they can blow a man off the back of a yak.

THE ESSENTIAL ANIMAL

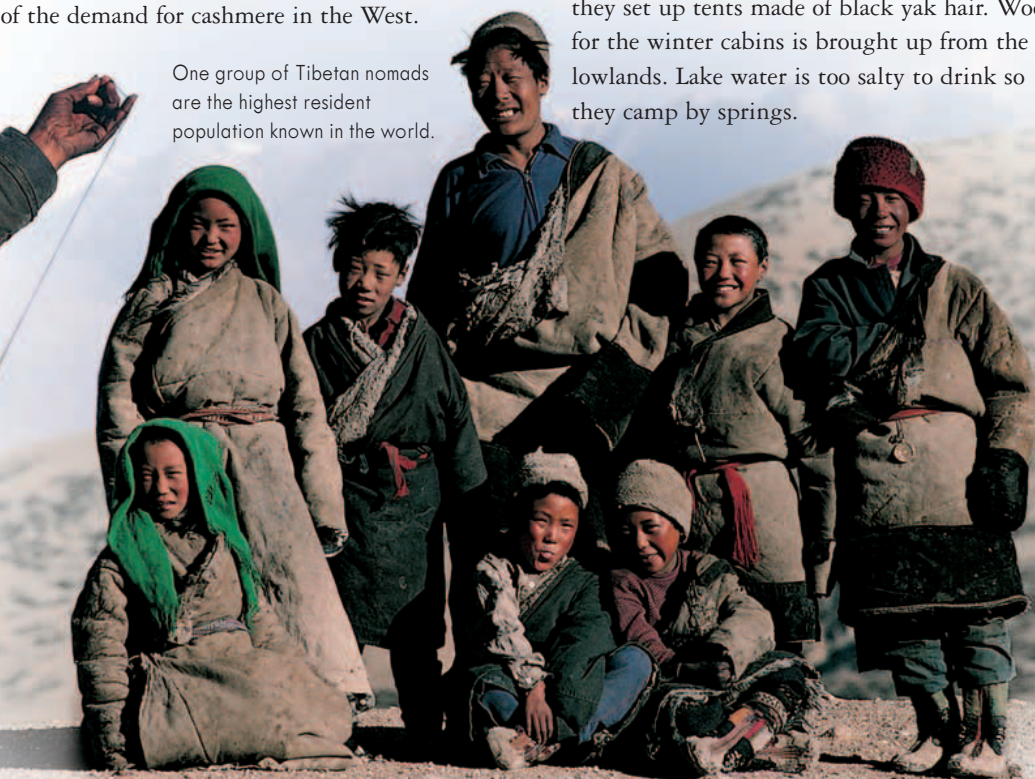
For centuries the nomads have been leading sheep, goats, and yak from pasture to pasture. The animals are used for food, transportation, clothes, and wool products. Cashmere wool from the goats has recently been lucrative because of the demand for cashmere in the West.

One group of Tibetan nomads are the highest resident population known in the world.



THE CAMPS

There is little or no wood on the plains of Tibet, so when the nomads move their herds around they set up tents made of black yak hair. Wood for the winter cabins is brought up from the lowlands. Lake water is too salty to drink so they camp by springs.



YAK MILK

Tibetan nomads live mainly on the foods derived from their animals, such as milk products. They use yak milk to make their butter tea, which consists of yak butter and salted black tea mixed together into a kind of broth.